



Gamma RP

1st Edition

A simple roleplaying system meant to be dynamic and expansible

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January 13, 2026

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Introduction

Gamma RP, or ΓRP, is a tabletop role-playing game (TTRPG) system meant to strike a balance between pure theater-of-the-mind systems and map based tabletop systems.

I've found that the most engaging TTRPG systems for me were ones that had a visual element, but these by necessity often put a lot of burden of preparation on the moderator(s) of the game. They also can indirectly limit the amount of improvisation possible by the players since the moderator needs to prepare visual assets based on what the players choose, and this slows down the game.

It also takes time away from world-building.

For me, the motivation for being the moderator (or game master, dungeon master, etc.) of a TTRPG is to build a world that my players can explore, interact with, and build characters and parts of the world themselves. I needed a system where any maps, items, or enemies could be very quickly created from scratch on-the-fly by an untrained game master.

So, faced with my perpetual scarcity of free time, I naturally decided to spend a few years creating ΓRP and the Gamma Nebula Setting before actually sitting down and playing with my friends.

The ΓRPsystem and the Gamma Nebula Setting are separated into different sections of this rulebook. The base system of rules is meant to be easy to build on top of, but the Gamma Nebula Setting is the setting that I initially built it for. Given how much work I've put into both, I am of the mind to release them together

for anyone else that may want to use the pre-built setting.

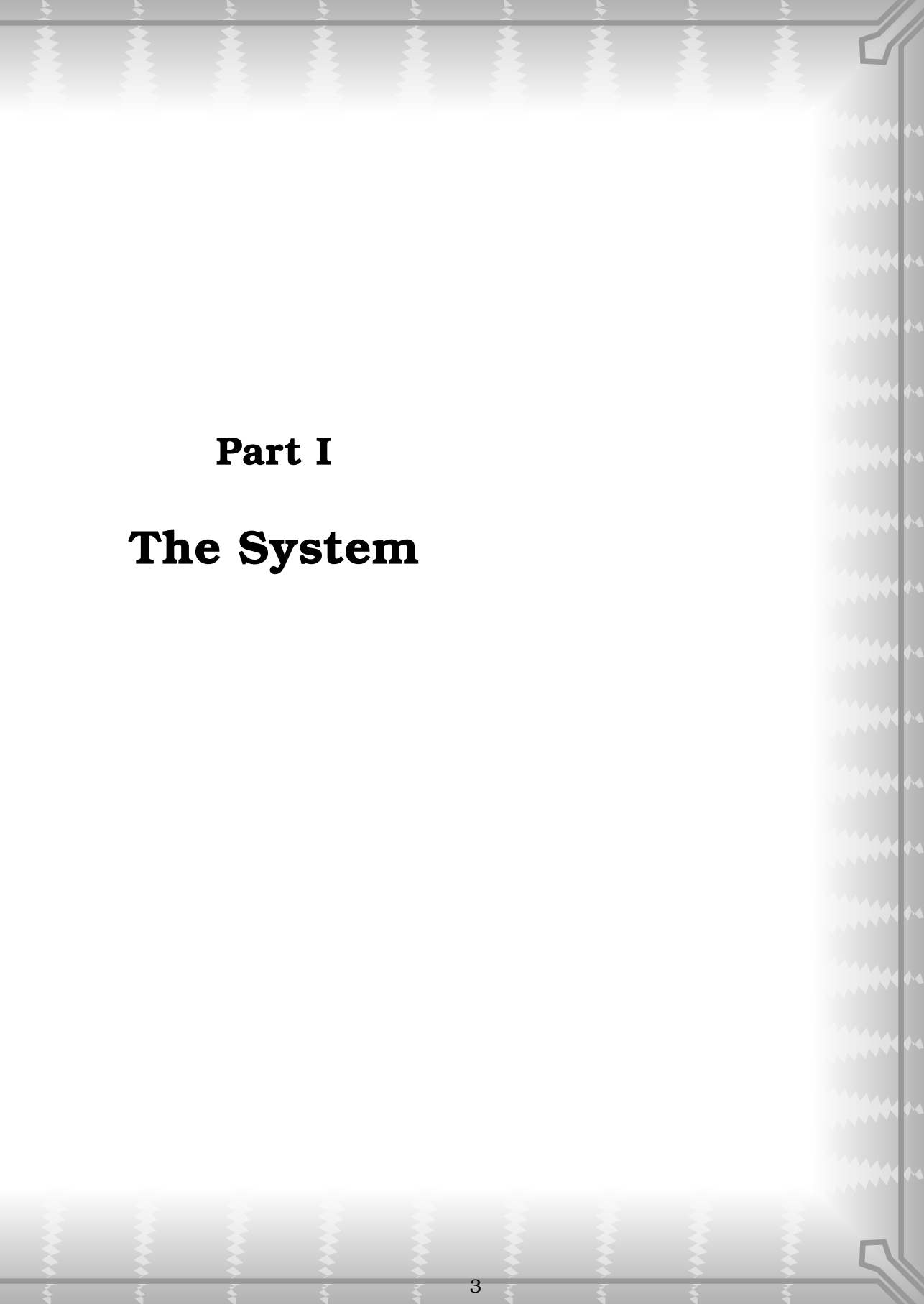
I heavily encourage any users of this system to build their own settings on top of this system.

I need to make this introduction more sensible and legible, but for now this placeholder will suffice!

Enjoy!

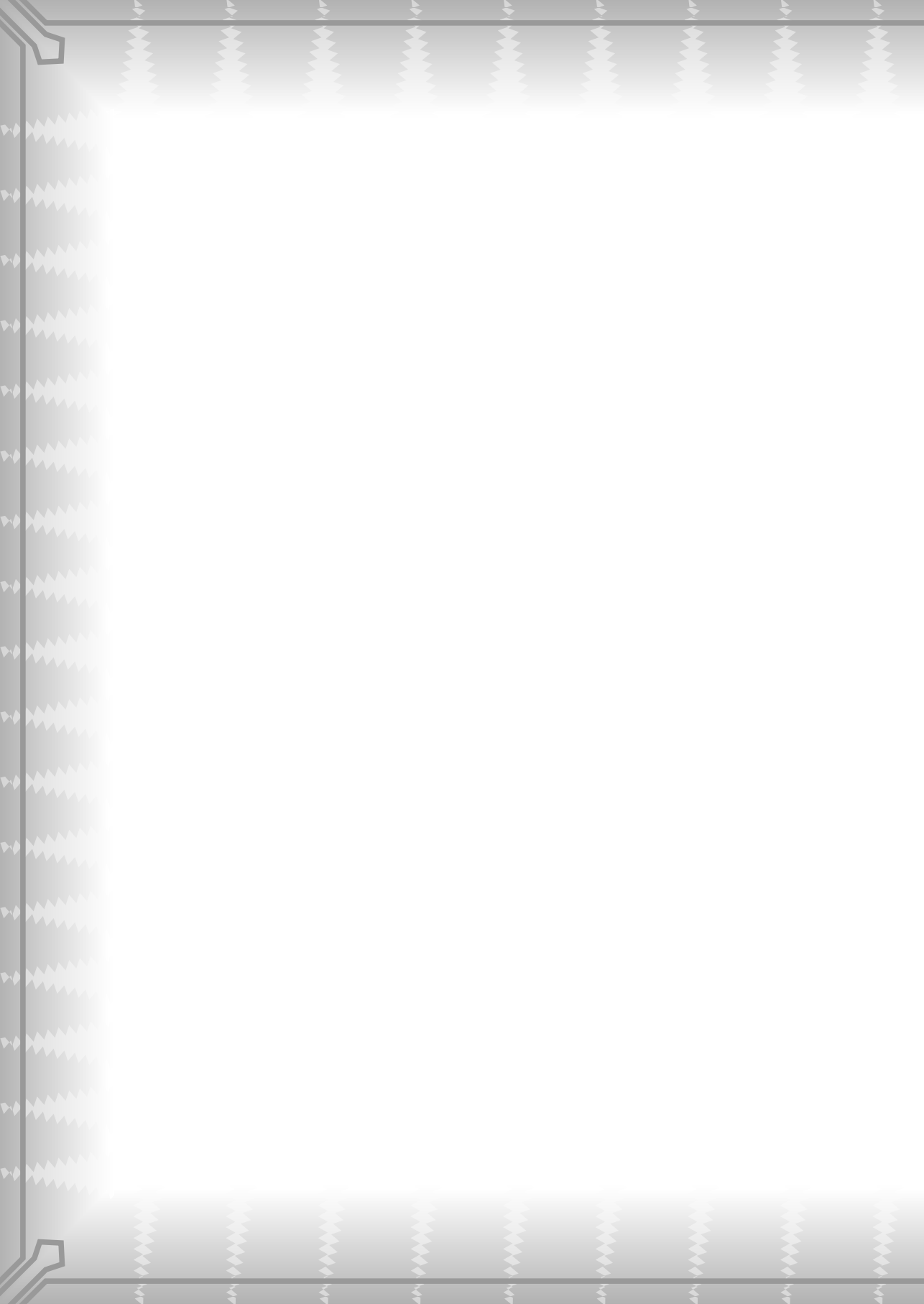
Here is a purely tikz generated logo attempt:

Gamma RP, or ΓRP is so cool that I use it to preserve food in my refrigerator



Part I

The System



2 The Basics

TRP is a tabletop role-playing game. This is a specific class of improvisational acting game in which the participants are divided into *Game Masters* (often referred to as GM's) and *Players*. Most games will require at least one game master in order to play the game, and the game master and players work together to tell a story.

The Game Master is responsible for constructing the world around the Players, and giving the players a setting to interact with. The Players are responsible for maintaining a Player Character—a character who interacts with and influences the setting defined by the Game Master.

Since the game is collaborative in this way, it is more fun and fair if there is an element of chance in deciding how a scene unfolds. TRP uses the roll of a set of dice to decide whether an unsure course of action is successful.

The fundamental dice mechanic in TRP is based on 12 sided dice, and rolls several at a time. If you intend to play the game on a real physical tabletop (rather than one of the increasingly popular virtual ones), you may want to obtain at least a dozen 12 sided dice for convenience. It is possible to play with fewer dice by rolling one die at a time.

2.1 Dice Rolling Basics

The notation for a roll in TRP is written as $RXaY$, which verbally is pronounced as “Roll X a Y”

X is the number of dice you roll.

Y is the *advantage* on the roll, which indicates that the top Y numbers of a die pass the success threshold.

If any of the dice you roll pass the success threshold, then your roll is a success. This means that both larger X and larger Y indicate a higher probability of success.

Let's look at a few example rolls.

Table 2a: Advantage Examples

ROLL	DICE	RESULT
R5a1	① ① ⑧ ④ ⑩	FAILURE
R5a1	① ① ② ⑫ ②	SUCCESS
R4a1	① ① ⑧ ⑩	FAILURE
R4a2	① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩	SUCCESS
R4a3	① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩	SUCCESS
R3a3	① ⑨ ⑧	FAILURE
R3a4	① ⑨ ⑧	SUCCESS
R3a8	② ④ ③	FAILURE
R3a9	② ④ ③	SUCCESS

The quickest way to judge if your advantaged roll is a success is:

1. Add the advantage to the value of each die in your roll
2. If $[ADVANTAGE] + [DIE\ VALUE] > 12$ for any die in your roll, your roll is a success.

An advantage of 0 is the exception to this

method: $RXa0$ is still successful if any of the dice roll a 12.

Advantage can also be negative. For convenience this is written as *disadvantage* which is the negative of the advantage. A roll of $RXa(-Z)$ is written equivalently as $RXdZ$.

For a roll at *disadvantage* of Z to be successful, in addition to having at least one die in the roll land on 12, there must also be at least Z dice within the roll displaying a number above 1.

Lets look at a few example disadvantage rolls.

Table 2b: Disadvantage Examples

ROLL	DICE	RESULT
$R2d1$	 	SUCCESS
$R2d1$	 	SUCCESS
$R2d2$	 	FAILURE
$R4d1$	   	FAILURE
$R4d2$	   	SUCCESS
$R4d3$	   	SUCCESS
$R4d4$	   	FAILURE
$R8d7$	       	FAILURE

The quickest way to judge if your disadvantaged roll is a success is:

1. Check if there are any dice showing 12 in your roll
2. Count the number of dice that show a value above 1
3. If $[NUMBER\ OF\ DICE\ ABOVE\ 1] > [DISADVANTAGE]$ for *any* die in your roll, and there is at least one die showing 12, your roll is a success.

When the disadvantage is greater than or equal to the number of dice being rolled, the roll is an automatic failure even if you have at least one dice showing a 12. This is because you do not have sufficient number of dice to show . Additionally, any roll with a disadvantage 12 or greater automatically fails, for symmetry with the advantage rolls (where any roll with an advantage 12 or greater automatically succeeds) If you are asked to make a roll with a disadvantage equal to or greater than the number of dice (or make a roll with a disadvantage greater than 12), you may simply declare a failure. However you may still make the roll if you have abilities that benefit from actually rolling the dice.

Note that the rolls $RXa1$, $RXa0$, and $RXd1$ are all actually identical, with all three requiring a single dice of the set to result 12 in order to result a success.

Table 2c: Probability of success for various rolls

$RXaY$	$RXd6$	$RXd5$	$RXd4$	$RXd3$	$RXd2$	$RXd1$	$RXa0$	$RXa1$	$RXa2$	$RXa3$	$RXa4$	$RXa5$	$RXa6$	$RXa7$
$R1aY$	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	8.3%	8.3%	16.7%	25.0%	33.3%	41.7%	50.0%	58.3%
$R2aY$	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	15.3%	16.0%	16.0%	16.0%	30.6%	43.8%	55.6%	66.0%	75.0%	82.6%
$R3aY$	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20.4%	21.6%	23.0%	23.0%	23.0%	42.1%	57.8%	70.4%	80.2%	87.5%	92.8%
$R4aY$	0.0%	0.0%	24.0%	25.7%	27.5%	29.4%	29.4%	29.4%	51.8%	68.4%	80.2%	88.4%	93.8%	97.0%
$R5aY$	0.0%	26.4%	28.4%	30.5%	32.8%	35.3%	35.3%	35.3%	59.8%	76.3%	86.8%	93.2%	96.9%	98.7%
$R6aY$	27.9%	30.1%	32.5%	35.0%	37.7%	40.7%	40.7%	40.7%	66.5%	82.2%	91.2%	96.1%	98.4%	99.5%

2.2 Modifying Rolls

Very often a character will have a default way they roll something in a situation, but the circumstances of the situation impair or improve their chances of success.

When this happens, it is often easier as a GM to specify the roll they must make as a modification of the dice or advantage of their usual roll.

2.2.1 Bonus and Penalty Dice

You should only modify the number of dice for a characters sparingly or if the rulebook specifies that you should do so. Modifying the number of dice is described using the terms “die bonus” and “die penalty”.

If the rules specify you take a W die penalty- then you roll with W fewer dice than you ordinarily would.

If the rules specify you take a X die bonus- then you roll with X more dice than you ordinarily would.

2.2.2 Additional Advantage and Disadvantage

Modifying the advantage and disadvantage on a roll may be done more freely by the GM. If the situation is harder than usual, the GM may impose “additional disadvantage” on the players. If the situation has been modified to be easier than usual, the GM may grant “additional advantage” to the players.

If the GM or the rules specify you take Y additional advantage- then you roll with Y higher advantage than you ordinarily would.

If the GM or the rules specify you take Z additional disadvantage- then you roll with Z lower advantage than you ordinarily would. Remember that $-Z$ advantage is the same as Z disadvantage. Rolling with additional disadvantage may still leave some net advantage to the roll left over.

Figure 2a: Exact mathematical formula for the probability of roll success

For the probability of success for a roll $RXaY$:

$$[\text{PROBABILITY}] = \begin{cases} \text{if } Y \geq 12, & 100\% \\ \text{if } 12 > Y > 0, & 1 - \left(\frac{12 - Y}{12}\right)^X \\ \text{if } Y = 0, & 1 - \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^X \\ \text{if } 0 > Y \geq -X, & \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^{(-Y-1)} - \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^X \times \left(\frac{10}{11}\right)^{(-Y-1)} \\ \text{if } -X > Y, & 0\% \end{cases}$$

2.3 Group Rolls

Sometimes you may want multiple characters all contribute effort to determine if they succeed at a task. You can do this

with a group roll.

The process of a group roll is as follows:

1. Each character making a group roll

makes the corresponding roll for the task

- Count the total number of successes among the group
- If $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}] \geq [\text{GROUP SIZE}]$ then the group succeeds at the roll.

If you need to count the number of successes for a group roll, it is $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}] / [\text{GROUP SIZE}]$ rounded **down** to the nearest whole number.

This may be most easily illustrated with an example.

GM: As you enter the swamp, the mud grows deeper and harder to trudge through. You'll all have to use your Fortitude talent to pass without hurting yourselves.

Alice: Can we make this a group roll? I think we could help each other cross.

GM: Absolutely. Make a group roll for Fortitude.

FORTITUDE GROUP ROLL

Bob: R2a3 - (8)(3)

Alice: R5a5 - (1)(8)(2)(5)(10)

Eve: R6a4 - (3)(7)(12)(4)(1)(2)

GM: Great. Between all of you you have 3 successes. Alice's extra success makes up for Bob's lack of success.

Bob- you stumble in the thick mud and almost land face first, but Alice catches you. You all struggle through and make it through the swamp without injury.

2.4 Roll Contests

Sometimes, one character may be asked to dynamically struggle against the abilities of another character or entity within the game. When this happens, the game enters a roll contest—where both characters roll against each other and apply penalties to the other's roll depending on how well they do.

The process of a roll contest is as follows:

- Both characters make their roll simultaneously.
- If one character is successful and the other is not, the successful character wins.
- If both characters are unsuccessful, return to step 1.
- If both characters are successful, the first character will be penalized dice equal to the number of successes of the second character, and vice versa. Return to step 1.
- If you have repeated this process to the point where one character has no dice remaining, the character who has dice remaining wins the contest.
- If both characters reach 0 dice simultaneously, both characters lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).

If there are no penalties for losing the contest, a simultaneous fail just ends the contest with no effect. Step 6 is only important when one of the characters has an ability that imposes a penalty for failing a roll.

Roll Contests are probably best illustrated with an example as follows.

Eve: Can I initiate a grapple on the guard?

GM: Sure! Go ahead and initiate a Roll Contest with Athletics.

Eve: I'll use my Dexterity talent since I'm much better at that.

GM: Sure, you can *talent proxy*. Use Dexterity at 2 additional disadvantage.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 1

Eve: R6a2 - ③ ⑤ ⑨ ① ④ ⑤

Guard: R4a4 - ② ⑧ ③ ②

Eve: Shoot.

GM: Don't worry, neither of you have any successes, so you'll roll again.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 2

Eve: R6a2 - ⑨ ⑪ ⑦ ② ⑥ ③

Guard: R4a4 - ⑨ ① ③ ⑩

GM: You grab the guard but he's wriggling out of your grasp. You'll roll with 2 fewer dice since he got 2 successes, and he'll roll with 1 fewer dice because you got 1 success. Go again.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 3

Eve: R4a2 - ⑫ ④ ① ②

Guard: R3a4 - ④ ⑦ ③

Eve: Yes! I succeeded and the guard did not.

GM: Great! You deftly bend the guard's arm and twist him into your awaiting chokehold. You've grappled the guard.

It is highly disrecommended to perform a *group roll contest*. For tasks of that complexity it is usually better to let the game enter phased mode- which will be described in detail later.

If you do find yourself in a situation in which a group roll contest is called for, the process is as follows.

1. Both groups make their group rolls simultaneously..
2. If one group is successful and the other is not, the successful group wins.
3. If both groups are unsuccessful, return to step 1.
4. If both groups are successful, the first group must be penalized a number of dice equal to the second group's number of successes, and vice versa. Every character in the group takes this penalty. Then return to Step 1.
5. If you have repeated this process to the point where one group has no dice remaining, the group who has dice remaining wins the contest.
6. If both groups reach 0 dice simultaneously, both groups lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).

3 Building a Character

The same character building process is used for non-player-characters (NPC's) and player characters (PC's). This chapter will indicate when something is nonessential for a non-player character.

For a step by step overview of the process of building a character, consider skipping to Section 3.9.

3.1 Experience Points

Experience points, or XP for short, are used to upgrade your character's abilities after creation.

You may apply XP to your character has whenever you take the *sleep* down-time action.

3.2 Fundamental Attributes

All characters have 6 fundamental attributes, divided into 3 *Foundations* and 3 *Characteristics*.

- **Foundations**—
Mind, Body, Heart
- **Characteristics**—
Precision, Strength, Grace

The foundations and characteristics are combined to form 9 fundamental *talents* that all characters have.

Table 3a: Combining Foundations and Characteristics to get Talents

	PRECISION	STRENGTH	GRACE
MIND	MEMORY R[MIND]a[PRECISION]	INTELLECT R[MIND]a[STRENGTH]	INSIGHT R[MIND]a[GRACE]
BODY	DEXTERITY R[BODY]a[PRECISION]	FORTITUDE R[BODY]a[STRENGTH]	ATHLETICS R[BODY]a[GRACE]
HEART	PERCEPTION R[HEART]a[PRECISION]	WILL R[HEART]a[STRENGTH]	CHARISMA R[HEART]a[GRACE]

When building a character, you have:

- 6 points to distribute among your foundations ([MIND], [BODY], [HEART]) as you see fit
- 8 points to distribute among your characteristics ([PRECISION], [STRENGTH], [GRACE]) as you see fit

You **must** allocate at least 1 point to each foundation and each characteristic.

The number of points you allocate to each fundamental attribute become the value of that fundamental attribute for the lifetime of your character and may not be changed after character creation.

However, you can gain aptitude in each

of the fundamental talents which give additional advantage to their rolls, and racial bonuses and skills may give you bonus dice on different rolls.

The 12 fundamental talents are meant to intuitively follow from their construction. If you are trying to determine what talents are applicable in a situation, simply consider:

- Does this situation need Precision, Strength, or Grace?
- Does this situation relate to the Body, the Heart, or the Mind?

Then, find the corresponding row and column on the talent grid, and roll that talent to determine success.

The GM ultimately determines if a talent applies in a narrative situation, and sometimes there may be more than one talent that is equally applicable. If the player can make an argument that the GM finds reasonable for why a talent is reasonable in a situation, they may roll that talent.

For clarity, what follows are descriptions of all the talents along with some example situations where they apply. This is not a comprehensive list.

- **MEMORY**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Mind, such as precise recall, exact pattern matching or recognition, or accurate calculation. Examples include:
 - A character is trying to recall if they've seen a symbol before in their past
 - A character is trying to determine which of two piles of material weighs more
 - A character is trying to determine if a language or code they are hearing is one they've heard before.
 - A character is trying to memorize instructions for a complex process
- **INTELLECT**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Mind– such as intense computation or decisions involving many simultaneous variables. Examples include:
 - A character is trying to decode a coded message
 - A character is coming up with the solution to a puzzle
 - A character needs to beat another character in a game of chess
- **INSIGHT**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Mind, such as nimble thinking or problems requiring the right inspiration to strike in a timely manner. Examples include:
 - A character is investigating a crime scene
 - A character is trying to invent a mechanism to close a door based on objects strewn around the area
 - A character is trying to discern the political motivations of an organization
 - A character is trying to escape a trap or legal dilemma

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- **DEXTERITY**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Body– think along the lines of quick and accurate reflexes. Examples include:
 - Aiming a ranged weapon at a moving target
 - Catching a rapidly moving small object
 - Disarming a delicate trap without triggering it
- **FORTITUDE**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Body– think along the lines of endurance and raw physical power. Examples include:
 - Withstanding the effects of a strong alcoholic drink
 - Carrying a heavy object for a period of time
 - Wading through thick mud or pushing through tangled vines
- **ATHLETICS**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Body– think along the lines of well developed martial form or postural technique. Examples include:
 - Throwing an object as far as possible
 - Arm wrestling another character
 - Rolling out of a fall to mitigate damage
- **PERCEPTION**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Heart. This applies to the accuracy of a character's emotional inspiration. Examples include:
 - Determining if another character is lying
 - Accurately guessing why another character is acting strange
 - Figuring out what is meaningful to another character
- **WILL**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Heart. This applies to determination and emotional centered-ness. Examples include:
 - A character is trying to withstand a psychic attack (or puppy-dog eyes)
 - A character is trying to power through pain to maintain focus on a task
 - A character is trying to resist the effects of a sedative
- **CHARISMA**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Heart. This can be thought of the character's ability to navigate emotional issues and convince other people to follow their lead. Examples include:
 - Persuading another character to give up an item
 - Rallying a crowd to perform an action
 - Deceiving another character about something

3.2.1 Talent Proxying

The various talents in TRP have significant conceptual overlap. In addition to the GM determining what talents are appropriate to a situation, players are allowed to use talents on the opposite side of the talent grid at 2 additional disadvantage. This is called talent proxying.

This encapsulates the fact that vastly different skills may be used to accomplish the same feat. For instance, the ability to remember details about what motivates people can substitute for the ability to appeal to their emotions, and in this way, the **MEMORY** talent may proxy for the **CHARISMA** talent. Fast enough reflexes would allow you to adjust your body in the right way to accomplish martial feats

that would usually require well developed form. Conversely, well developed form can substitute for fast and accurate reflexes. Therefore **DEXTERITY** and **ATHLETICS** can proxy for each other.

You can also proxy **FORTITUDE** with either **INTELLECT**, **DEXTERITY**, **WILL**, or **ATHLETICS** at 4 additional disadvantage.

This is meant to represent the fact that physical problem solving (Intellect), accurate enough reflexes (Dexterity), dogged enough determination (Will), or well developed form (Athletics), can all substitute for raw power when overcoming physical challenges or physical impairment.

What follows are visual diagrams showing what talents can be proxied for others.

Figure 3a: Talents you can proxy at -2a

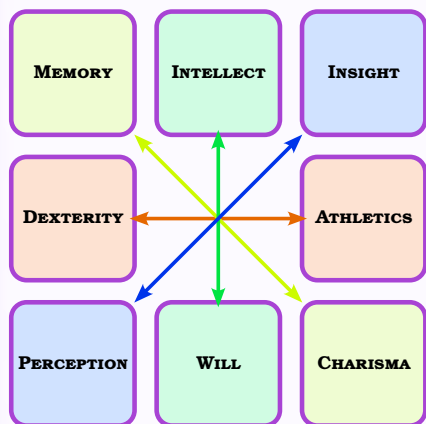
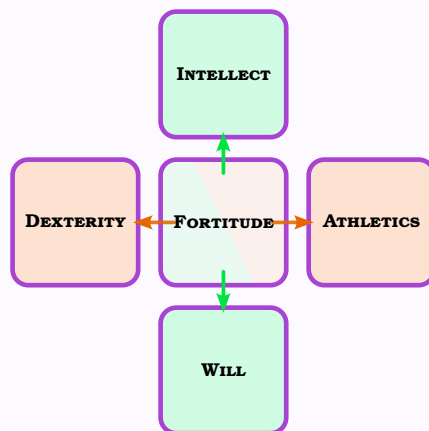


Figure 3b: Talents you can proxy at -4a



You can gain aptitude ranks in your talents by spending XP. Each aptitude rank gives 1 additional advantage when rolling the talent.

It costs:

- 1 XP for the first aptitude rank
- 2 XP for the second aptitude rank
- 3 XP for the third aptitude rank.

You may have a maximum of 3 ranks

in any talent.

3.2.2 Depleting Fundamentals

In a pinch, you may *deplete* your foundations and your characteristics for certain bonuses.

Each time you *deplete* a fundamental, you incur an additional -1 penalty to that fundamental. This penalty persists until you next take the *sleep* downtime action.

You may not deplete your foundations or characteristics below 0.

Note that if you deplete your [MIND], [BODY], or [HEART] to 0 you will **automatically fail all rolls related to these foundations.**

You may still proxy a related talent to avoid failing the roll.

If you deplete 2 of your foundations ([MIND], [BODY], or [HEART]) to 0, your character falls *unconscious*. Your character may return to consciousness by having one of their foundations restored.

If you deplete all 3 foundations ([MIND], [BODY], and [HEART]) to 0, your character is *dead*. If your character is dead- talents, abilities and items that normally restore foundation depletion will not work, and they must be restored to life by other means.

Any or all of a character's characteristics ([PRECISION], [STRENGTH], or [GRACE]) may be depleted to 0 without causing unconsciousness or death.

3.3 Wounds

Each time a character receives a wound, they must choose a foundation ([MIND], [BODY], or [HEART]) to deplete by 1.

When a character's wound is healed, that character may choose any depleted

foundation to be restored by 1 (even if that particular foundation was not depleted by that particular wound).

The **Robust** skill (described in Section 3.8) allows a character to take some wounds before needing to deplete any foundations.

3.4 Species Bonuses

The species of a character provides bonuses to some of their talents. Each species provides either of 1 bonus dice to 5 talents or 2 bonus dice to 2 talents.

The species bonuses are described for each species in Chapter ??.

3.5 Archetypes

Your character has an archetype- a way that their fortune tends to run in certain situations. This consists of a general type of *situation* and the type of *fortune* they have in this situation.

Your character starts with 1 archetype rank, and additional ranks may be added for 3 XP each. You may have a maximum of 4 archetype ranks.

You may choose to accumulate bonus archetype ranks during the day by *depleting* 1 from Grace for each bonus rank. Bonus archetype ranks may exceed the usual maximum ranks of 4.

Situations:

- **Social**- all circumstances in which the character is trying to influence the actions or words of other characters in the world around them. Recieve +1 to Grace.
- **Technical**- all circumstances in which the character is trying to create or modify something in the world around them. Recieve +1 to Precision.
- **Martial**- all circumstances in which the character is in combat or physical contest (with the environment or another player). Recieve +1 to Strength

(continued...)

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Fortunes:

- **Adept**– For any roll in your situation, you may adjust any die by up to [RANKS] values AFTER rolling.
- **Awkward**– Up to [RANKS] times a day, you may choose to automatically fail a roll in your situation in order to gain 4 bonus dice on your next roll (in any situation).
- **Confident**– Once a day, after making a successful roll in a situation, you may choose to gain 6 advantage for the next [RANKS] consecutive subsequent rolls in that situation. You must do this before seeing the results of any of the subsequent rolls.
- **Duplicitious**– When your character is in a contested roll in the situation, you may swap up to [RANKS] of your rolled dice with your opponent's rolled dice (even if your opponent is inanimate or the environment). Your number of successes still depend on how much advantage you had on your original roll, and your opponent's number of successes still depend on how much advantage they had in their original roll.
- **Judicious**– Roll [RANKS] dice at the beginning of the day. You maintain a pool of [RANKS] dice that starts initially populated by your first rolls. In any archetype situation- you may swap any number of dice in your pool with dice in your roll, AFTER seeing the result.
- **Lucky**– A number of times equal to your number of archetype ranks, you may choose to automatically succeed on a roll in this situation. You must choose to do this before seeing the result of the roll.
- **Oblivious**– Up to [RANKS] times a day in your character's situation, you may ignore a roll and force a reroll, AFTER seeing the result, and you may reverse decisions about whether you used another ability to alter the dice roll before rerolling it.

3.6 Loadout Overview

A character's *loadout* refers to the set of equipment and abilities that they currently have access to. In TRP these are split into three categories: Casts, Augments, and Equipment.

Since there are numerous options for each of the loadout categories, this section will simply describe the function of each loadout category without listing all the options. For more details on various loadout options, skip to Chapter ??.

For NPC's a GM may consider skipping

fully defining a loadout. In most situations an NPC will function even if the loadout has sections that are not defined.

3.6.1 Casts

Casts are special abilities that may be used a limited number of times each day.

A character may only have a fixed number of *prepared casts*. On creation, a character's [MAX PREPARED CASTS] is equal to their [MIND] score. They may prep more casts than this by depleting their

[MIND] score by 1 for each additional cast prepared. The [MIND] score depleted by overprepping casts may be restored by unprepping these casts.

In order to prepare a cast, a character must possess a cast focus corresponding to that cast. Most cast focuses are Wt 0 and cost 100 gold. Once a cast focus is in a character's possession it may be used as many times as desired to prepare that cast. A cast focus may be spell notes that a character has written themselves, or a series of runes that they use to imbue themselves with power, or even a device they activate which creates an effect on demand.

A character may only activate any of their prepared casts a fixed number of times between downtimes. On creation, a character's [MAX CAST ACTIVATIONS] is equal to their [PRECISION].

To be clear, all of these cast activations may be due to the same cast being used, but a character may only cast a number of times equal to [MAX CAST ACTIVATIONS] without penalty. They may cast more than their usual max by depleting their [PRECISION] by 1 for each time they exceed [MAX CAST ACTIVATIONS].

Options for casts in the base system are specified in Section ??.

3.6.2 Augments

Augments are devices, implants, or enhanced body features that grant a character extra abilities.

A character's [MAX AUGMENTS], the number of augments they may have active without penalty, is initially equal to their [HEART] score. They may have more active augments than their [MAX AUGMENTS] by depleting their [HEART] score for one by every additional augment they keep active. The [HEART] score depleted by overactivating augments can be restored by deactivating augments over the limit.

Each augment in general gives a char-

acter access to one ability.

The exception is *attunements* which are special augments that give a character access to a skill tree that can be invested in with XP. Each attunement counts as **two** augments. Attunements can be very powerful but can be riskier- if a character is *disabled* and has to deactivate an attunement, they will lose access to the entire skill tree provided by an augment.

Options for augments in the base system are specified in Section ??

3.6.3 Equipment

On creation, a character's [EQUIP Wt], the total weight of equipment they can have actively equipped is equal to their [BODY] score. If a character equips equipment in excess of the [EQUIP Wt], they will *deplete* their [BODY] score by 1 for each additional weight unit of equipment they equip. The [BODY] score depleted by overequipping equipment may be restored by unequipping the additional equipment.

Equipment is divided into weapons, tools, armor, and accessories. A character may only have one piece of armor equipment actively equipped. A character may have any number of weapons, tools and accessories actively equipped as long as the sum of their weights does not exceed the character's [EQUIP Wt]

Only actively equipped items may be accessed without penalty when the game is in *phased* mode.

On creation, a character's [PACK Wt], total weight of things they can have in their personal inventory (aside from equipment you currently have actively equipped) is equal to their [STRENGTH] score. Having more weight than this in their inventory will *deplete* their [STRENGTH] score by 1 for each additional weight unit of items they have in their inventory. The [STRENGTH] score depleted by carrying too many items may be restored by dropping items in their inventory.

Options for equipment in the base system are specified in Section ??.

3.6.4 Changing Loadout

If you change your loadout of active augments, inventory items, or prepped casts during *phased* (turn-based) gameplay, you will *deplete* your [GRACE] score. You may change your actively equipped items without penalty during phased gameplay, but note that pulling items out of your pack to do so will still deplete your [GRACE].

You can change any part of your

loadout without penalty during *asynchronous* (non-turn-based) gameplay however many times you like.

3.7 Languages

Languages may be modified to be setting specific in GRP, but there are 6 languages that are referred to in the base system listed in this section.

A character starts knowing Standard, and depending on your character's species may know one other language by default. Your character may learn a new language by investing 3XP.

- **Standard**– A common language spoken by most groups of sentient creatures. A cultural relic of a vast empire that fell a long time ago which has been preserved in present-day cultures.
- **Leesong**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Avian species.
- **Chitter**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Weaver Species.
- **Wake**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Aquatic species.
- **Slewbask**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Reptilian species.
- **Prineu**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Homonid species.

All of these languages may come in different dialects which are not interchangeable. This is ultimately up to the GM to decide to add more languages to the setting.

3.8 Skills

Skills are things your character has trained in which confer various benefits. You must invest in skills with XP in order to use them.

It costs:

- 1 XP for the first rank in a skill
- 2 XP for the second rank in a skill
- 3 XP for the third rank in a skill.

Each skill may only be listed once (with the exception of the “Experienced” skill), and you may have a maximum of 3 ranks in any skill.

What follows are descriptions of all the skills your character can take.

- **Augment Mastery**– for each rank in augment mastery, you may increase your [MAX AUGMENTS] by one.
- **Marathon Caster**– for each rank in marathon caster, you may increase your [MAX CAST ACTIVATIONS] by one
- **Versatile Caster**– for each rank in versatile caster, you may increase your [MAX PREPARED CASTS] by one.
- **Robust**– you may take wounds up to [RANKS] in Robust without depleting any of your fundamentals. Once you exceed this number of wounds you will start depleting fundamentals as usual in response to sustaining a wound.
- **Porter**– for each rank in porter, you may increase your [PACK Wt] by 1.
- **Walking Armory**– for each rank in Walking Armory, you may increase your [EQUIP Wt] by 1.
- **Agile**– While the game is in *phased* mode, during your offensive phase your character gains 1 additional action for each [RANK] in Agile.
- **Responsive**– While the game is in *phased* mode, during your defensive phase- if your character's defensive action is triggered, roll **DEXTERITY** with [RANKS] additional advantage. If successful, your character may take one offensive action of their choice after taking the defensive action that was triggered.
- **Linguist**– Whenever you must roll for any sort of communication involving a language your character does not know, you may do so with [RANKS] additional advantage.
- **Experienced in [topic]**– pick a topic your character is experienced in. The topic must be much more specific than "social," "martial," or "technical." Whenever your character is rolling in a situation relating to this topic, gain [RANKS] bonus dice to your roll. You may take this skill multiple times as long as the topic is unique for each listing.

Examples of topics for Experienced:

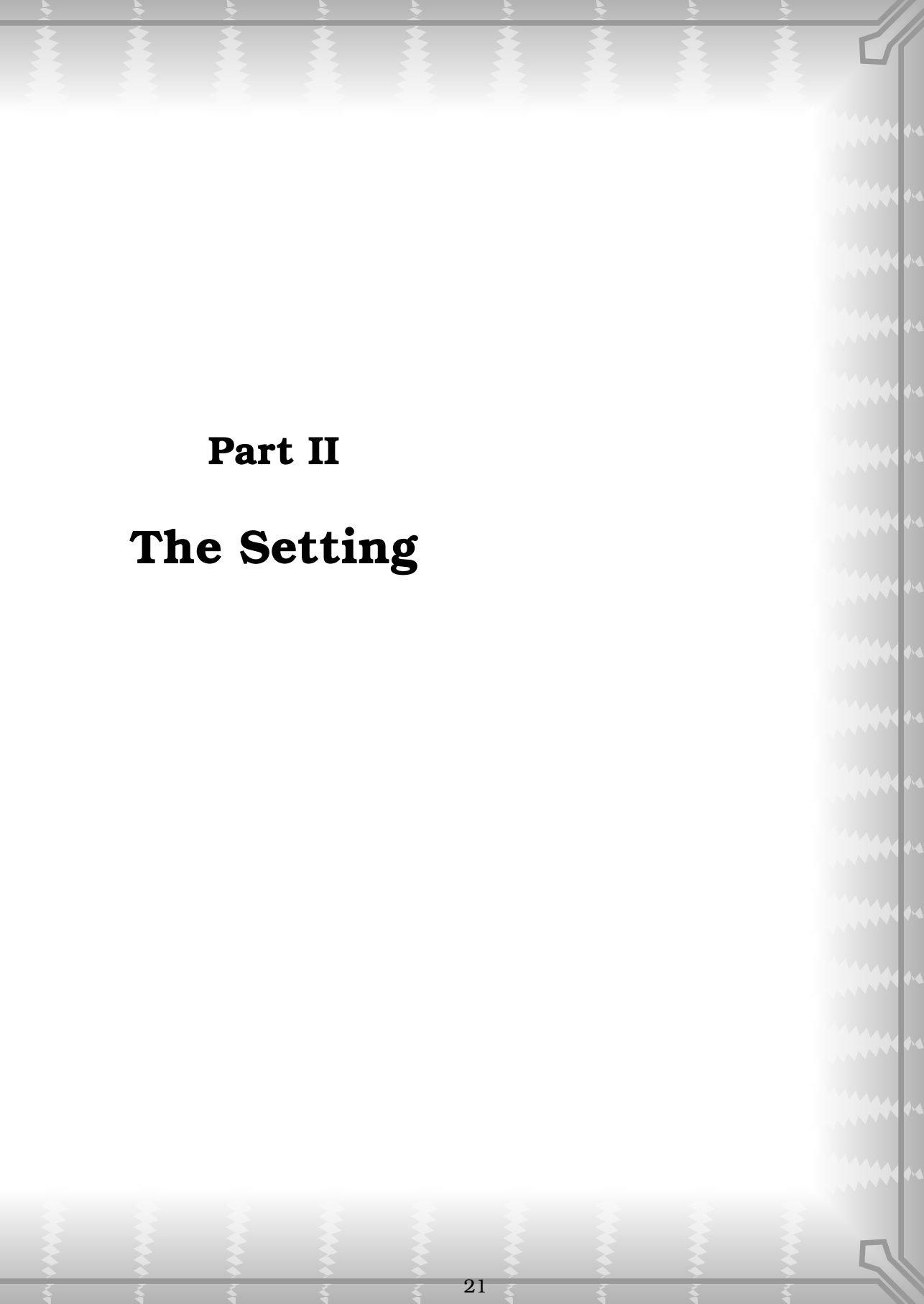
- A specific class of spaceships
- A specific type of magic
- A specific type of weapon
- A specific culture
- A specific technology

The GM of a game can decide if the topic your character has picked is specific enough for the Experienced skill. If a topic you've already chosen seems too broad after a few sessions of play, the GM can ask you to narrow your topic. If a topic you've chosen seems too narrow after a few sessions of play, you may ask the GM to broaden your topic.

3.9 Character Building Overview

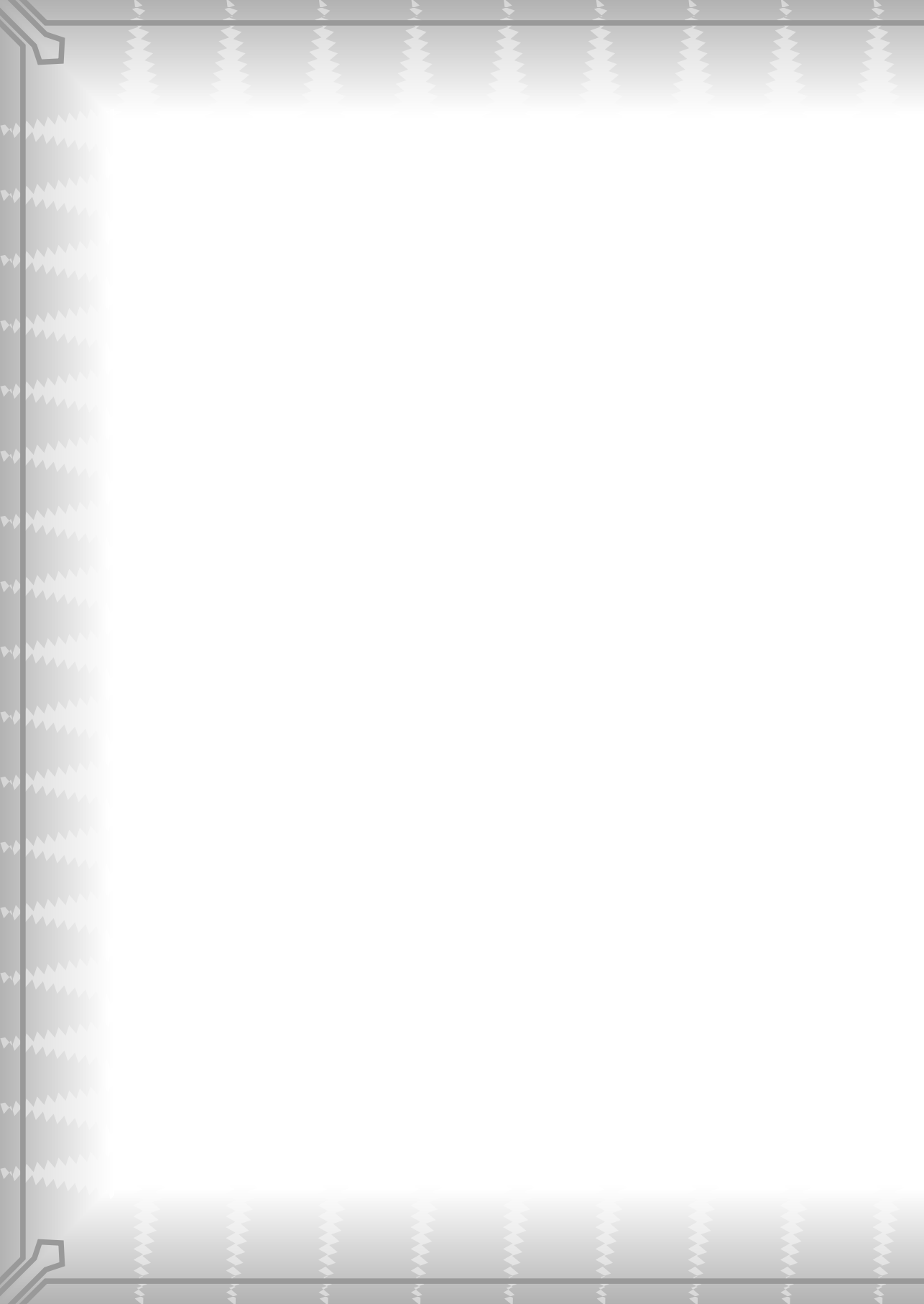
For convenience, this section is a consolidated step-by-step guide to building a character. You may follow along with the example character sheet at the end of this section.

1. Chose your Fundamentals. Your foundations ([HEART], [BODY], and [MIND]) should all sum up to 6. Your characteristics ([PRECISION], [STRENGTH], [GRACE]) should all sum up to 8. The minimum value of any of these fundamentals is 1.
2. Choose a species. Apply any bonuses to talents. Take note of any species abilities.
3. Set your [MAX CAST ACTIVATIONS] to your [PRECISION] score, and set your [MAX PREPARED CASTS] to your [MIND] score.
4. Choose a number of casts



Part II

The Setting



Overview of the Gamma Nebula

Gamma Nebula is a futuristic setting in another universe where advanced magic has enabled space exploration. The physics and the rules of the Gamma Nebula universe are very different to our own. Gamma Nebula has its own cosmology, history, and cultures, but a Game Master using the setting is encouraged to invent their own.

This book will lay out a framework of the galaxy and the way it works, but the details are left up to the Game Master and players, who may improvisationally create planets and peoples.

It's a big galaxy out there, with surprises and mysteries both ancient and new.

4.1 A brief history

The Gamma Nebula setting takes place in a galaxy called the Great Spiral. There are currently approximately 100 known inhabited worlds in the great spiral governed by the Galactic Alliance, and linked through Fey Space by Fey Corridors.

More than 100,000 years ago, an event called The Great Collapse occurred that formed the universe. Scholars theorize that prior to this event, many of the planes that are currently wrapped into small dimensions used to be as accessible as the material plane, and that the universe was a much bigger place previously, though it may have been inhospitable to existence as we know it. The general consensus from both high level clerics and ancient artifacts obtained from Pla-

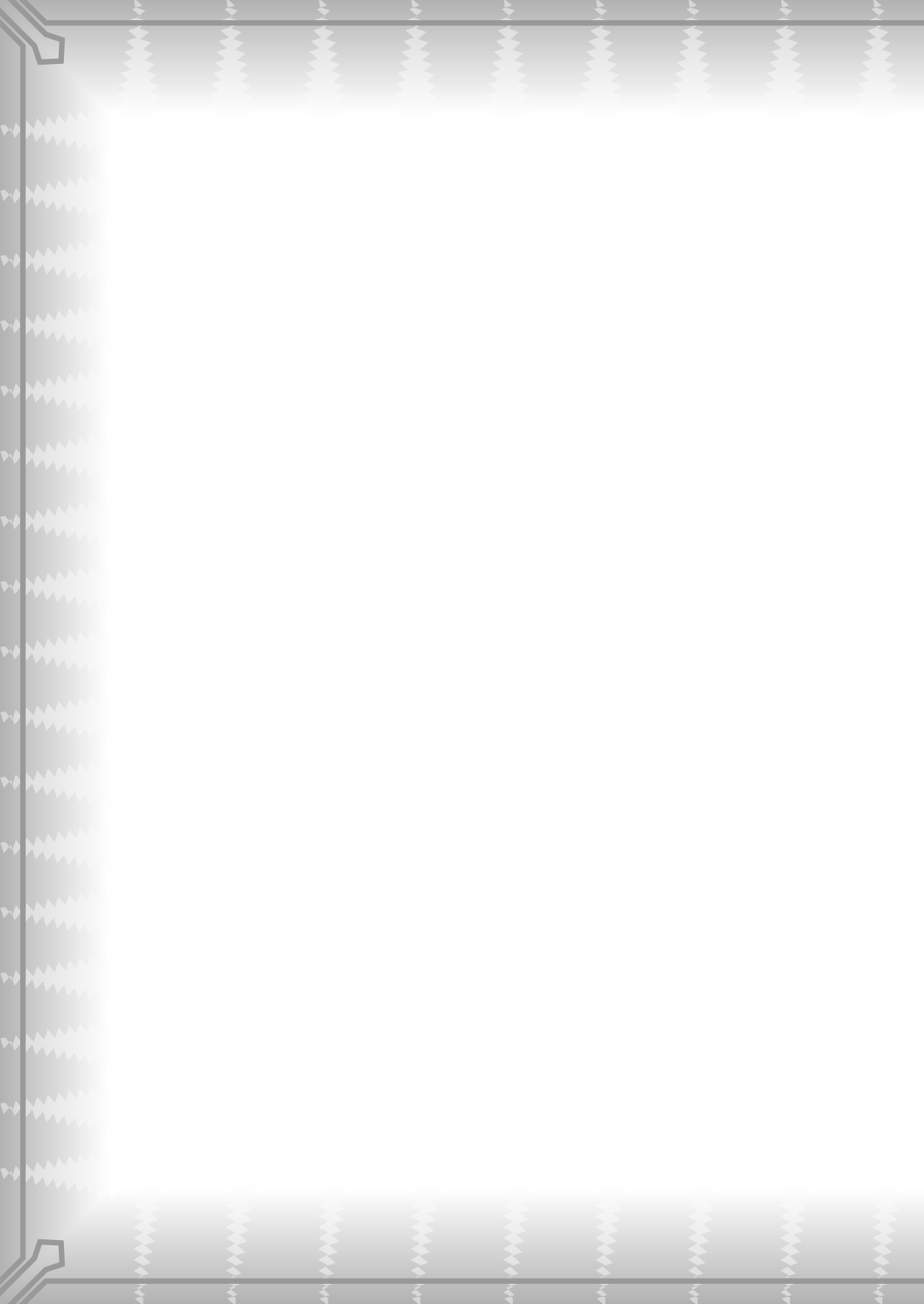
nar Pockets is that The Gods had something to do with this, and that The Great Collapse and the creation of this universe was an attempt to prevent a great force of destruction from overcoming them and the life that came before.

Within the first 10000 years after The Great Collapse the dragons built the Fey Corridor network. A flourishing galactic civilization of more than 2000 worlds was formed with numerous species using the network for communication and trade. The vast majority of the details of this civilization were lost during the Spiral War 40,000 years ago. All Fey Corridors were unusable for the first 1000 years after the Spiral War, and many Fey Corridor openings were completely destroyed or became permanently inoperable. Vast amounts of knowledge and technology were lost during that time. The technology used to create the Fey Corridors is slowly being rediscovered and some Fey Corridors are being restored. Unfortunately not all Fey Corridors can be restored because both ends of a Fey Corridor must be restored. For many known Fey Corridor openings, the location of another linked opening is not known and thus a viable corridor cannot be established. There are an estimated 1000 Fey Corridors that could be restored if the other opening could be physically accessed and repaired. These nonfunctioning fey corridors are said to lead to Lost Worlds, which may very well harbor life and a society disconnected from the Galactic Alliance. There have been 3 Lost Worlds which have had a civilization which restored their side of a Fey Corri-

dor Opening and rejoined the Galactic Alliance. All others have been restored from the side of the burgeoning Galactic Alliance.

Part III

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